

AGREEMENT

BETWEEN THE



BOARD OF EDUCATION

COMMUNITY CONSOLIDATED SCHOOL DISTRICT 46,
GRAYSLAKE
LAKE COUNTY, ILLINOIS

AND THE



GRAYSLAKE FEDERATION OF TEACHERS

A COUNCIL OF THE
LAKE COUNTY FEDERATION OF TEACHERS LOCAL NO.
504, IFT-AFT/AFL-CIO

FOR THE SCHOOL YEARS

2025-2026

2026-2027

2027-2028

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PREAMBLE

A. Parties to the Agreement

This Agreement is made and entered into by and between the Board of Education of Community Consolidated School District 46, Grayslake, Lake County, Illinois, hereinafter referred to as the "Board" and the Grayslake Federation of Teachers, a Council of the Lake County Federation of Teachers, Local 504, IFT-AFT, AFL-CIO, hereinafter referred to as the "Union."

B. Recognition

The Board hereby recognizes the Union as the exclusive and sole negotiating agent for all employees occupying positions for which certification is required, with respect to wages, hours, terms and conditions of employment. This Agreement excludes all personnel who are enumerated as exclusions in the Illinois Educational Labor Relations Act (IELRA).

The term "certified staff member," when used hereinafter in this Agreement, shall refer to all professional teaching personnel defined above in the negotiating unit.

The Union recognizes the Board as an Employer as defined in the Illinois Educational Labor Relations Act. As such, the Board shall not be required to bargain over matters of inherent managerial policy, which include such areas as the functions of the employer, standards of services, its overall budget, the organizational structure and selection of new employees and the direction of employees.

ARTICLE 1

UNION RIGHTS

A. Bulletin Boards

The Union shall have the right to post notices of its activities and matters of Union concern on bulletin boards, at least one (1) of which shall be provided by the Board for each school building in the faculty room. Defamatory notices shall not be posted under this provision.

B. Faculty Mailboxes

The Union shall have the right to use faculty mailboxes for announcements relating to the conduct of the Union's business.

C. Use of School Facilities

The Union may use the District buildings for Union meetings at times other than normal working hours and hours of student instruction. The Union President or designee shall make the District Superintendent or designee aware of the union meeting at least two (2) school days prior to the event including which building will be in use. Use of space shall be pre-approved using the central scheduling system. Access to the central scheduling system shall be provided to the Union President. Unless an emergency situation arises, the Administration and Union shall schedule no meetings on days that shall conflict with existing items on the calendar. When special custodial service is required, the Board may charge according to Board Policy.

D. School Equipment

The Union shall have the right to use school equipment at reasonable times on school premises when such equipment is not needed for District purposes. The Union shall pay for the reasonable cost of all materials and supplies incident to such use. Central office computer equipment is excluded from this provision.

E. Dissemination of Information to the Union

On request, the Union shall be furnished for review at the District Administrative Office, all regularly and routinely prepared information concerning the financial condition of the School District including the annual financial statement and adopted budget. In addition, the Board and the Administration shall grant reasonable requests for any other readily available information, which may be relevant to negotiations. Nothing herein shall require the Administration to research and assemble information.

Copies of approved Board minutes shall be emailed to the Union President through administrative channels prior to the next regularly scheduled Board meeting after which the minutes were approved.

The District will provide the following information to the Union ten (10) calendar days prior to the beginning of every school term and every 30 calendar days thereafter in the school term, in an Excel file, for all bargaining unit personnel:

- Employee's name
- Job title
- Worksite location
- eHome address

- Work telephone numbers
- Identification number
- Home and personal cellular telephone numbers on file with the employer
- Date of hire
- Work email address
- Any personal email address on file with the employer
- Employee status, either active, on unpaid leave, or separated from employment.

In addition, the Board shall provide the Union with the salary placement and job assignment for all new hires by September 21.

For an employee hired after the beginning of the school term, the District shall provide the Union with the above information within ten (10) days of hiring such employee.

The Union shall be notified within three (3) business days of the employer's receipt of a Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) request that asks for information about any bargaining unit member, including, but not limited to, names, email addresses, any part of a home address, or list of members of the union, dues payers, or non-members.

F. Grayslake Gate Clause

No person shall be permitted to monitor or record by mechanical means, any Union meeting or educational activity involving certified staff members and students without their knowledge.

G. Dues Deduction

The Board shall deduct from the pay of each certified staff member's current membership dues of the Union provided that at the time of such deduction there is in the possession of the Board a current authorization for dues deduction executed by the certified staff member. The amount specified shall be prorated and deducted from the certified staff member's paychecks commencing with the first paycheck in September and terminating with the last paycheck in May. All dues deducted by the Board shall be transmitted to the Treasurer of the Union or designee within thirty (30) calendar days of their receipt.

Authorized deductions shall be irrevocable except in accordance with the terms under which an employee voluntarily authorized said deductions. Dues revocations are processed by the Union. In the event an employee revokes their dues in accordance with the terms under which they authorized the dues deductions, the Union will notify the employer. The Union shall in all respects indemnify and hold harmless the Board from all claims, demands, suits and costs resulting from the Board's good faith administration of this provision.

H. COPE Deduction

Upon receipt of a voluntary authorization in writing by a certified staff member, the Board shall deduct from the certified staff member's salary the amount authorized by the certified staff member for the Lake County Federation of Teachers Committee on Political Education (COPE). Such deduction shall be made the last paycheck in October and forwarded to the Treasurer of the Union not more than fourteen (14) days after such deductions were made along with the amount deducted for each certified staff member. The Union shall defend and hold the Board harmless for any action properly performed pursuant to this Section.

Union dues and COPE deductions shall be mailed in separate checks.

I. Union Business

In the event that the Union desires to send representatives on business pertinent to Union affairs, said requests shall be considered for approval, provided:

1. Written request for leave has been approved by the Superintendent or designee.
2. Such requests shall not exceed four (4) school days per year.
3. The District shall pay for up to four (4) school days of substitutes per year for the Union President or their designee.
4. The frequency is not to impair the quality of classroom instruction.

J. Mutual Communications

Upon request by either party, the Union President and the Superintendent or designee shall discuss matters relating to the implementation of this Agreement, individual building working conditions, and other subjects that may be relevant to both parties.

K. Union Officers Release Time

The Union Officers, collectively, shall be granted release time of thirty (30) workdays without deduction in pay for the purpose of conducting in-District Union business. Administrative requests for attendance of Union Representation at specific meetings shall not be deducted from the allocated days. Further, if a meeting is disciplinary in nature, and a certified staff member has requested representation, these meetings shall not be deducted from the allocated days. The Superintendent or designee may grant additional days without precedential effect.

L. Leadership Liaison

1. Building Leadership Liaison

Each building shall establish a Building Leadership Liaison Committee composed of union members as appointed by the Union President and one (1) or more building administrator(s) and/or designees. Unless mutually agreed otherwise, said Committee shall meet at least once per calendar month, September through May, to review matters relevant to the operation of the building and recommend constructive solutions to problems. Each meeting shall include an agenda that will be mutually agreed upon by both parties and shared with committee members no less than twenty-four (24) hours in advance of the scheduled meeting indicating the items the parties wish to discuss. Unresolved items from the Building Leadership Liaison Committee may be referred to the District Leadership Liaison Committee, the Superintendent and/or designees.

2. District Leadership Liaison

A District Leadership Liaison Committee shall be composed of union members appointed by the Union President. Such Committee shall have the right to meet with the Superintendent or designee and/or designees to discuss matters relevant to the operation of the school district and recommend constructive solutions to problems. Said Committee shall meet at least four (4) times during the school year, unless mutually agreed otherwise. Each meeting shall include an agenda that will be mutually agreed upon by both parties and shared with committee members no less than forty-eight (48) hours in advance of the scheduled meeting indicating the items the parties wish to discuss.

M. Employee Orientation

The Union shall be provided up to one (1) hour to meet with newly hired employees for an orientation without charge to pay or leave time of the employees or Union representatives, on the employer's premises, at the beginning of the school year, and upon hire of new employees after the start of the school year.

ARTICLE 2

CERTIFIED STAFF MEMBER RIGHTS

A. Affiliation

Certified staff members shall be free to join or not to join any organization representing certified staff members without interference or penalty. Certified staff members shall not be encouraged or discouraged by the Board to join any Union.

B. Certified Staff Member Protection

Any complaint by a parent deemed to be of serious nature by the Building Principal shall be communicated to the certified staff member(s) toward whom the complaint was directed within a reasonable time, normally not to exceed two (2) school days.

C. Vacancies

The Board shall distribute a weekly email and post on the district website notice of vacancies existing in all staff positions for the following year as they occur. Any certified staff member wishing to be considered for building, subject, or grade level transfers or positions, must notify the Office of the Superintendent or designee in writing within seven (7) calendar days of the posting of the position and fill out a truncated version of the District application for internal candidates. The District will work with the Union through Union/Administration meetings to identify necessary items for a truncated application for internal candidates. During the summer months, such requests shall be made within five (5) calendar days of the mailing of such notice. The certified staff member must include their reasons for the transfer or promotion and the school and/or positions desired.

D. Transfers

1. Transfers, defined as a change of assignments between buildings, shall occur only after volunteers are considered first. Reassignments within the building between positions is considered managerial right.
2. When a reduction in sections or an elimination of a position, within or between buildings, necessitates an involuntary reassignment of more than one certified staff member (i.e., There is a loss of a position in fourth grade and an opening in second grade; the administration desires to move a fourth grade teacher to third grade and a third grade to second grade.), the union and all affected certified staff members must be consulted beforehand. If after an involuntary reassignment due to reduction in force has occurred, the original position becomes available within two (2) academic years, the certified staff member shall be permitted the original position, if requested.
3. Conditions listed above do not preclude Administration from transferring a tenured or non-tenured certified staff member who is agreeable to said transfer.
4. If a staff member requests a transfer to another building or position within the same classification, the Board agrees to give consideration to seniority, experience, educational background, attainments, and other relevant factors. Should a transfer not be granted, an explanation will be provided.

E. Curriculum and Inservice Development

Certified staff members shall have an opportunity to become involved in the area of curriculum development and instruction, in-service training and selection and adoption of educational materials. Adoption and approval of all policies and programs in curriculum shall be at the sole discretion of the Board.

Vacancies for positions on established or newly formed curriculum committees shall be emailed to certified staff members and the Union. Certified staff members will share interest in joining a committee through a survey. Once interest is identified, the Administration shall appoint committee members with every effort to provide representation from all schools, grade levels, and positions as appropriate for the committee and after consultation with the Union President. Certified staff members will be limited to two (2) committees per school year whenever possible. If the Administration is unable to fill a committee position with a volunteer from the list, the Administration will reach out to the Union President for help to recruit additional certified staff members. Certified staff members showing interest in participation on a committee will be notified within seven (7) certified staff member attendance days of the interest survey completion date as to their status of participation on the committee. During the course of this agreement, the Union will be provided with a list of people requesting committee work as well as the list of people appointed to each committee.

Certified staff members (including classroom, special education, specialists and other supporting staff) who are creating curriculum, participating in curriculum re-writing, presenting to other Certified staff members or new or existing curriculum and/or "like" activities shall be given time during the contractual day or if participating on a curriculum or in-service committee that meets outside of the school day shall be paid at the "active curriculum" hourly rate of \$40.00 per hour. Curriculum and in-service development will be a collaborative effort between the administration and staff previously specified. Prior to the implementation of any new curriculum or units developed, the actual implementers of the curriculum will be given time to review and provide feedback on the proposed curriculum or in-service. If pre approved curriculum or in-service work is necessary during the summer months, compensation shall be paid at the "active curriculum" hourly rate of \$40.00. Certified staff members who attend professional development as a "sit and get" after the regular work day or during summer hours shall be paid a "passive curriculum" hourly rate of \$30.00.

F. Physical Examinations

If a medical examination is required by the Board at a time other than regular examination periods, specific reasons shall be given to the certified staff member for requiring such examination and the Board shall bear the cost of the examination.

G. Assignments and Workload

All certified staff members shall be given written notice of their assignments for the forthcoming year no later than May 15th of the preceding school term. In the absence of such notice, the certified staff member shall assume the same assignment as they held in the preceding school year. Should previously unforeseen situations create the necessity of a change in assignment, the certified staff member shall be notified of such change in assignment as soon as possible, but not later than fourteen (14) calendar days after such change. If a certified staff member feels a change in assignment is unjust or unnecessary, the certified staff member shall have the right to confer with the Building Principal and/or Superintendent or designee.

Each certified staff member shall have access to a list of all students with IEPs, 504s or ML categorization assigned either to their classroom or workload no later than seven (7) calendar days prior to the start of the school term, or two school days after the student is so assigned after the start of the school term and the IEP, 504, or ML categorization becomes available.

Certified staff members shall also be given electronic access to view student IEP or Section 504 paperwork at the same time. Furthermore, reasonable effort shall be made to allot time during the first two (2) days of certified staff member attendance for special ed, general ed, and ML certified staff members to meet in order to discuss students with IEPs, 504s, and ML categorizations.

During the school year, certified staff members shall be given notice of new student assignments as soon as possible after the administrator makes such determination.

Certified staff members may be assigned the responsibility of providing an academic intervention for students as long as their schedules provide for contractual planning time. Certified staff members who provide academic interventions for students will be provided appropriate training.

H. Job Descriptions

The District will provide the Union with job descriptions of any newly proposed or created job(s) requiring a PEL and/or covered by the recognition clause of this contract for review and input prior to presenting to the Board of Education for final approval.

During the 2025-2026 and 2026-2027 school years, a joint committee will be formed to review existing job descriptions for certified staff members. Missing job descriptions will be created with input from the Union. The purpose of the review is to determine if job descriptions are accurate. Any revised job descriptions will be provided to the Union and the impacted certified staff member.

I. No Reprisal

There shall be no reprisal by the Administration or the Board toward any member of the faculty for legal Union activities. The Board shall not discriminate against any certified staff member with respect to conditions of employment by reasons of their Union membership or their participation in negotiations with the Board, nor shall the Board discriminate against any certified staff member for their institution of any grievance, complaint or proceeding under this Agreement. The Board of Education will expect that non-Union members will not be treated in a discriminating manner by those who are members of the Union. There shall be no reprisal or discrimination by the Union toward any member of the faculty for participation or non-participation in the above stated activities.

J. Summer School

If the Board conducts a summer school program, certified staff members shall be notified by email of anticipated opportunities in the summer school by May 15, and from time to time thereafter as new information becomes available. Where possible, classroom certified staff members from the District, qualified and experienced in the subject matter, shall be hired to teach summer school.

Summer school coordinators shall be hired by January 15 whenever the Board conducts a summer school or ESY program.

K. Disciplinary Conference

1. Prior to any suspension, the certified staff member charged shall be notified in writing of the charges by the Superintendent or designee at least one (1) day prior to a meeting with the Superintendent or designee. The certified staff member charged shall have the

right to explain or rebut the charges at a meeting with the Superintendent or designee. Following this conference with the Superintendent or designee, the certified staff member shall have the right to a hearing with the Board of Education relative to the charges underlying their suspension.

2. In such conferences, the certified staff member shall have the right to have a representative of their choosing.

L. Copy Machines

The Board of Education has the responsibility for the operation and equipping of school facilities. The Board of Education will make a diligent effort within the financial ability of the School District to maintain a reasonable number of copy machines in appropriate locations in each of the school buildings. Certified staff members shall report issues with the copy machines via the tech help desk system and receive notice of the anticipated timeline for resolution. In the event that copiers are unavailable due to mechanical issues, the union and building principal will consult on the means of completing essential copying jobs until such time as the staff copier(s) is(are) functioning.

M. Telephones

The Board of Education has the responsibility for the operation and equipping of school facilities. The Board of Education will make a diligent effort within the financial ability of the School District to maintain a reasonable number of telephones in appropriate and reasonably private locations in each of the school buildings. Certified staff member input and suggestions are encouraged and may be made in writing to the building administrator.

N. Building Access

The Board of Education will make a diligent effort within the financial ability of the School District to provide reasonable access to school buildings during non-work hours.

O. Secure Storage Areas

The Board of Education will make a diligent effort within the financial ability of the School District to provide secure storage areas for certified staff members' personal effects in each school building.

P. Students with Medical Needs

Other than Epi pens and AED machines, no certified staff member, except a certified school nurse or non-certified registered professional nurse, shall be required to administer medication to a student or be required to feed students that require a feeding tube. Training will be provided to all certified staff members regarding the use of Epi pens and AED machines.

Q. New Certified Staff Member Institute Days

Three (3) weekdays shall be scheduled for the purpose of new teacher institute days of which time will be allowed for introduction to the district's technology and equipment, individual teacher classroom preparation, introduction to the Union, the Illinois Federation of Teachers' New Member and Professional Partner Program, if available, and District Office explanation of employee benefits. New certified staff members will receive compensation of \$30 per hour for attendance at New Teacher Institute Days.

R. Certified Staff Members' Absences

All reading, ML, and resource certified staff members shall have a substitute in their absence. All certified staff must enter their absences in the District's substitute system. Resource certified staff members who are not teachers of record shall be offered up to three (3) days of professional development opportunities each year that do not require a substitute in their absence.

S. Seniority

For purposes of determining a certified staff member's seniority, the date of hire will be determined as follows:

A current certified staff member's date of hire will be the date of the certified staff member's acceptance of the district's conditional job offer.

For all current certified staff members for which the date of certified staff member's acceptance cannot be determined, the certified staff member's date of hire will be the date listed on the district's seniority list. In case of a tie, a random method, agreed to by the Superintendent or designee and Union President, will be used to break the tie.

For all certified staff members hired after June 30, 2014, the certified staff member's hire date shall be determined by the date and time of the acceptance of the District's conditional job offer.

T. School Calendar

The Administration shall consult with the Union and make a reasonable effort to agree upon a recommendation for the following year's calendar prior to the Administration's recommendation to the Board of Education.

ARTICLE 3

EVALUATION AND FILES

A. Evaluations

1. Evaluations of certified teaching staff shall be done by administrators who meet state requirements. Such a qualified administrator is hereinafter referred to as "evaluator."
2. The Administration shall acquaint new certified staff members with the evaluation procedures, standards and instruments to be used by September 15th. Within thirty (30) school days after the start of the school term, the Administration shall advise certified staff members as to who shall be their primary evaluator to observe and evaluate performance. When buildings share certified staff members, all administrators involved will collaborate to formulate one overall final evaluation report. Other administrative personnel within the school district may be invited by an administrator or the staff member to give input into the evaluation. Their comments shall be attached to the staff members' evaluation instrument. The actual conferences and the final report will be completed by the primary evaluator.
3. Each year, certified staff members shall come up with goals related to their professional growth. There is no magic number of goals. At least one of your goals should pertain to a school goal. The school improvement plan is available in your staff handbook. The goals should be focused on student learning and growth. All goals should be measurable and observable.
4. The actual evaluation cycle shall be: Non-tenured certified staff members shall be formally evaluated annually. Every effort shall be made to conduct at least one (1) formal observation prior to November 30 and at least one (1) formal observation to be completed by March 1. Certified staff members in contractual continued service (tenured) shall be formally observed at least one (1) time in the course of every three (3) school years. However, notwithstanding the foregoing, a school principal may formally observe any certified staff member within a school during his or her first year as principal of such school.
5. When an evaluator plans to visit a certified staff member for the purpose of a formal observation, the evaluator and the certified staff member shall agree at least one (1) week before the observation. A Pre- Observation form is to be completed by the certified staff member prior to each formal classroom observation to help the certified staff member and supervisor determine the primary focus of the observation. A pre-observation conference will be held. A formal observation for the purpose of evaluation shall be defined as an observation of not less than forty-five (45) continuous minutes or a time period as otherwise permitted by law or regulation. No observation shall take place on the day immediately following or preceding a recognized school holiday. The results of any informal observation(s) shall also become part of the formal evaluation. Informal observations an evaluator intends to include in the formal evaluation shall be communicated to the certified staff member in writing (email) within two (2) working days of the occurrence of the informal observation. The evaluator shall make their presence known to the certified staff member upon entering the classroom or work area. The evaluator will record performance information gathered during an observation. After a formal observation, the certified staff member will complete a Post Observation Reflection to be submitted two days prior to the post-observation conference. The certified staff member will complete the Self Evaluation Summary form to bring to the post-observation conference.
6. Following each formal observation, the evaluator shall complete a written evaluation of the observation. Within ten (10) school days of the observation, the evaluator shall hold a conference with the certified staff member to discuss the findings of the observation. Information discussed in the post observation conference will reflect the evaluation criteria included in this document. The evaluation conference shall include a discussion of the draft of the written evaluation including strengths and weaknesses, and the evaluator shall

identify deficiencies in the certified staff member's performance and recommend and provide remedial help when appropriate.

7. Within fifteen (15) school days of the observation, the principal will furnish the certified staff member with a final copy of the written evaluation. Both the evaluator and the certified staff member shall date and sign all copies of the written evaluation. The signature of the certified staff member shall not necessarily indicate agreement with the written evaluation, but rather shall indicate that the conference and discussion have been held and that the certified staff member is in receipt of a copy of the written evaluation.
8. If the certified staff member feels their formal written evaluation is incomplete, inaccurate or unjust, the certified staff member may put their disagreement(s) in writing. Both the certified staff member and evaluator shall date and sign all copies of the written disagreement(s). The signature of the evaluator shall not necessarily indicate agreement with the written response(s), but rather shall indicate that the evaluator is in receipt of a copy of the written response(s). A copy of the written response(s) shall be attached to the written evaluation. Any written response must be within thirty (30) school days of the evaluation conference.
9. If a tenured certified staff member receives an overall "Needs Improvement" performance rating, within five (5) school days, they may request one follow-up formal observation. This formal observation shall take place within fifteen (15) school days from the date of the request. The information received from the follow-up formal observation will be considered along with the previous informal and formal observations in determining the certified staff member's summative performance rating.
10. A copy of all formal written evaluations and any attached written response(s) shall be placed in the certified staff member's official personnel file.
11. The evaluator or other appropriate administrator shall advise the non-tenured certified staff member following the second or final evaluation of the probability for continued employment.
12. Each certified staff member who is evaluated in a given year, whether tenured or non-tenured, shall receive one (1) summative rating for that school year without regard to the number of evaluations and/or evaluation observations which occur. The summative rating shall be issued no later than March 1 for non-tenured Certified staff members, and no later than May 15 for tenured Certified staff members. This shall not apply to Certified staff members under a professional development plan or remediation plan.

B. Professional Development Plans

Within thirty (30) school days after the summative evaluation of a tenured certified staff member has been reduced to writing resulting in a rating of "Needs Improvement," a professional development plan designed to correct the areas identified as needing improvement will be developed by the evaluator, in consultation with the certified staff member rated as needing improvement.

1. The professional development plan period will customarily be in effect until the certified staff member's next evaluation.
2. In the year following a tenured certified staff member's rating of "Needs Improvement," the evaluator shall conduct a final evaluation of the certified staff member with a rating given prior to seventy-five (75) days before the last day of school

3. A certified staff member who fails to complete the professional development plan with an evaluation rating of "Proficient" or better shall be placed on a remediation plan.

Appeals of Unsatisfactory Evaluation Ratings:

The process for appealing an unsatisfactory evaluation rating is identified within the CCSD 46 Teacher Evaluation Document

C. Remediation Plans

Timeline:

Within thirty (30) calendar days after the summative evaluation of a tenured certified staff member has been reduced to writing resulting in a rating of "Unsatisfactory," a remediation plan designed to correct the areas identified as unsatisfactory will be developed and initiated by the evaluator, the certified staff member, and consulting certified staff member.

1. The remediation plan shall provide for mid-point and final evaluations and ratings to occur during the ninety (90) school day remediation period.
2. The mid-point and final evaluations and ratings shall be conducted by a qualified Administrator.
 - a. When a quarterly evaluation schedule requires an evaluation after the close of the school year, but on or before July 15. Such evaluation shall be scheduled to occur no later than two (2) weeks prior to the close of the preceding school year.
 - b. When a quarterly evaluation schedule requires an evaluation after the close of the school year, but after July 15, such evaluation shall be scheduled to occur not later than two (2) weeks after student attendance commences in the following school year.
 - c. Failure to strictly comply with the timeliness for the required evaluations because of events such as summer months, illness, or certain leaves granted certified staff members under a remediation" plan shall not invalidate the results of the remediation plan.
3. The remediation plan shall provide reinstatement to a schedule of triennial evaluations for any certified staff member who successfully completes the one (1) year Remediation Plan by receiving a "Proficient" or better rating. The triennial schedule will be immediately reinstated if the deficiencies are satisfactorily remediated prior to the year's end.
4. The consulting certified staff member shall be informed, through a conference with the evaluator and the certified staff member under remediation, of the results of the mid-point evaluation in order to continue to provide assistance to the certified staff member under a remediation plan. Any certified staff member who fails to complete the ninety (90) school day remediation plan with a "Proficient" or better rating shall be dismissed in accordance with Section 24-12 of The School Code.

Participants:

Participants in the remediation plan shall include, the certified staff member deemed unsatisfactory, an evaluator, and a consulting certified staff member. The remediation plan may include the participation of other personnel to assist in correcting areas identified as unsatisfactory or other persons representing the certified staff member's interests.

Consulting Certified Staff Members:

1. A certified staff member shall be eligible to work as a "consulting certified staff member" provided the certified staff member meets the following criteria:
 - (a) Is a certified staff member as defined by this Agreement
 - (b) Has at least five (5) years of teaching experience.
 - (c) Has reasonable familiarity with the assignment of the certified staff member to whom they may serve as consultant.
 - (d) Has received an "Excellent" rating on their most recent evaluation.
2. The Board shall furnish the Union with a roster of all Certified staff members qualified as consulting Certified staff members and shall update such roster from time to time as names are added or deleted. The roster shall include the discipline and/or qualified teaching area of each certified staff member. When a consulting certified staff member is needed and written notice of such is delivered to the Union, the Union shall submit to the evaluator a roster of at least five (5) qualified Certified staff members or all such qualified Certified staff members if that number is less than five (5). The evaluator shall choose the consulting certified staff member from the roster submitted by the Union. Should the Union fail to submit a roster within ten (10) school days of receipt of request for such roster, then the evaluator may select the consulting certified staff member, provided however that the selected consulting certified staff member is not a newly eligible certified staff member that was unknown to the Union.

Participation in this plan by the consulting certified staff member shall be voluntary. A consulting certified staff member may withdraw at any time without penalty. Written notification of withdrawal is required.

If the consulting certified staff member becomes unavailable during the course of the remediation plan, a new consulting certified staff member shall be selected in the same manner as the initial consulting certified staff member. The remediation plan shall be amended as necessary upon consultation with the new consulting certified staff member.

Where no consulting certified staff member is available, the District shall request the State Board of Education to provide a consulting certified staff member. The State Board of Education shall thereupon provide a consulting certified staff member who meets the requirements.

3. Consulting certified staff members shall be compensated by stipend and/or release time appropriate to the anticipated extent and nature of such consultation. The amount and nature of such compensation shall be as agreed between the Board, the Union and the consulting certified staff member.
4. The Board shall hold harmless consulting Certified staff members from any legal liability arising from the performance of their responsibilities as consulting Certified staff members.

The consulting certified staff member shall not participate in any of the required evaluations, nor be engaged to evaluate the performance of the certified staff member under remediation.

D. Personnel Files

1. The Board shall maintain one (1) official individual personnel file for each member of the teaching staff. The location of such file shall be made known to all parties involved. Materials legally designated as confidential which were submitted in application for employment shall be excluded from review by the certified staff member.

2. All certified staff members shall have on file a complete and up-to-date transcript of all college work. Transcripts for advanced college work shall be filed on or before September 30th if consideration for salary advancement is requested for that year.
Transcripts received after September 30th, but on or before January 30th of any school year, shall allow for credit on the salary schedule to be one-half (1/2) the total amount.
3. No person(s) shall remove any material from a certified staff member's individual personnel file without the expressed written consent of both the Superintendent or designee and the certified staff member.
4. A certified staff member shall have the right to copy any material in their individual personnel file.
5. Any document in the personnel file of a certified staff member shall be signed by the person placing such document in the file. In addition, each certified staff member shall be given the opportunity to acknowledge that document has been placed in the certified staff member's personnel file by signing such document.
6. The certified staff member shall have the right to attach and place therein written reactions to the contents.

E. Grievability

Any grievance filed relative to evaluations shall be limited to violations of the specified language and procedures as outlined in Sections A, B, and C above. All other aspects of evaluation shall not be grievable.

F. Use of AI in Certified Staff Member Evaluation Process and/or Employment Decisions

The District agrees that AI shall not be used to assign a rating for the certified staff member evaluation process and/or employment decisions, in lieu of a qualified human evaluator.

Any introduction of AI tools, specifically for evaluation and employment decisions, are subject to prior negotiation with the Union.

ARTICLE 4

LEAVES

A. Sick Leave

Each regular full-time certified staff member shall receive a sick leave allowance of sixteen (16) days per school year for personal and family illness. A part-time certified staff member shall be entitled to an appropriate proration of the sick leave allowance accorded to the regular certified staff member. There shall be no limit to accumulation of sick leave. Any amount of sick leave over 340 days shall be payable to staff upon retirement at 50% of their per diem rate.

Beginning with the 2025-2026 school year, each full-time tenured certified staff member who has completed fifteen (15) consecutive years of District 46 service and who has not declared an intent to retire prior to the 2029-2030 school year will receive a one-time grant of an additional sixteen (16) sick leave days.

In each subsequent school year, each full-time tenured certified staff member upon completion of fifteen (15) consecutive years of District 46 service and who has not declared an intent to retire will receive a one-time grant of an additional sixteen (16) leave days which shall be granted the first day of the certified staff member's sixteenth year.

Sick leave shall include absence caused by injury, personal illness, quarantine at home, or serious illness or death in the immediate family or household.

Immediate family is defined as parents, stepparents, spouse, domestic partners, brothers, sisters, children, stepchildren, grandparents, grandchildren, parents-in-law, brothers-in-law, sisters-in-law, daughters in law, brothers in law, and legal guardians of the employee.

If a certified staff member's accumulated sick leave has been exhausted, the deduction for each additional day of lost teaching time shall equal the certified staff member's daily salary rate based on the number of days in the current school year.

Of the annual allowance of Sick Leave days per school year, up to four (4) may be used as personal leave days but no more than three (3) may be used consecutively, but shall be accumulated as sick leave days. The purpose of personal leave days is to conduct business, which cannot be conducted outside of the work day. The conditions under which personal leave shall be granted are:

1. Prior notification to the District through the absence reporting system.
2. No more than eight percent (8%) of the total faculty can use a personal day on a given day.
3. Personal leave shall not be honored on the following school days: testing weeks, Parent-Teacher Conference Days, or Back to School Night without prior approval from the Director of Human Resources.

B. Religious Leave

Staff members shall be allowed to use up to two (2) religious leave days and up to two (2) sick leave days with pay per year for required observance of a recognized religious holiday of the staff member's faith, when such observance is not possible outside of working hours.

Religious days will not be deducted from the staff member's allotted paid time off. The staff member shall notify the Building or District Administrator of intended use of religious leave under this Section at least two (2) school days prior to such use, and shall include the holiday for which the day or days shall be used. Religious leave days are not eligible to carry over from one (1) year to the next.

C. Bereavement Leave

Bereavement Leave of up to five (5) days with pay and without loss of sick leave shall be granted for each death in the immediate family. Immediate family shall be defined as parents, stepparents, spouses, domestic partners, brothers, sisters, children, stepchildren, grandparents, grandchildren, parents-in-law, brothers-in-law, sisters-in-law, legal guardians, daughters-in-law, and sons-in-law. Bereavement Leave of one (1) day with pay and sick leave deduction shall be granted for each death of nieces, nephews, aunts, uncles, cousins and grandparents-in-law. An additional five (5) days may be taken unpaid or using sick time, if available. The leave must be taken within sixty (60) days of the notification of death. The District may request reasonable documentation to verify the need for leave. FBLA also provides additional bereavement benefits for certain circumstances involving loss of pregnancy or fertility issues. The Superintendent or designee at their discretion may grant additional bereavement leave upon such terms and conditions as determined by the Superintendent or designee.

D. Unpaid Leave of Absence

1. Sick Leave

Sick leave shall not be applicable during the period of any unpaid leave of absence, except as expressly provided herein.

2. Combination of Leaves

A certified staff member may take sick leave followed by an unpaid leave of absence (non-disability) as long as the latter leave is taken in accordance with Section 3a. and 3b. below.

3. Unpaid Leave of Absence (Non-Disability)

a. Application

- (1) A certified staff member who wishes to take an unpaid leave of absence from the district for a purpose other than disability shall make the request of the Superintendent or designee sixty (60) days prior to the onset of the requested leave. The leave shall not exceed the balance of the school term in which it commences and one (1) additional school term. "School term" is defined as that portion of the school year when school is in session.
- (2) Any certified staff member desiring adoption leave as a result of becoming an adoptive parent shall notify the Superintendent or designee, in writing, upon the initiation of such adoption proceedings. Leave shall be granted upon satisfactory written notification to the Superintendent or designee of the date the child is expected to be received. It shall be the responsibility of the applying certified staff member to keep the Superintendent or designee informed on the status of the proceedings, and, as soon as known, the expected date of custody. This section shall not apply if the adopted child is six (6) or more years of age at the time the child is received.

b. Conditions

The granting of any unpaid leave of absence other than disability will be conditioned on the following:

- (1) The ability of the Superintendent or designee to maintain the continuity of instruction. The Superintendent or designee shall consider pertinent time factors (e.g., grading periods) and the needs of the certified staff member, including medical-related factors.
- (2) The Superintendent or designee and the certified staff member agree on the dates of commencement and termination of the leave. Every effort shall be made to have the leave (or contiguous sick leave) begin and end prior to the start of a new school term.
- (3) The granting of the leave is discretionary with the Superintendent or designee. The granting of a leave shall be without precedential effect.
- (4) Any accumulated sick leave available at the commencement of the leave shall be available to the certified staff member upon return to employment in the District.
- (5) With the consent of the carrier, the certified staff member may maintain insurance benefits by making timely payments of all premiums which may be due to the District's Business Office or elsewhere pursuant to its discretion.
- (6) Any certified staff member who has been employed ninety (90) or more school days in a school year shall be entitled to the CBA salary increase for the following year of work.
- (7) In all instances where a certified staff member is granted an unpaid leave of absence (non-disability) of eight (8) calendar months or more, as a condition thereof, he or she shall advise the Superintendent or designee in writing no later than March 15th prior to the termination of such leave that he or she intends to return to employment. Failure to advise the Superintendent or designee of intent to return as required by the preceding sentence shall constitute an election not to return to employment and resignation from the District.
- (8) An unpaid leave of absence (non-disability) may be granted to a non-tenured certified staff member under unusual circumstances by action of the Board, subject to all the conditions applicable to a tenured certified staff member, and provided the term of such leave shall not be considered in computing full-time employment under Section 24-11 of The School Code for purposes of the continuous employment necessary to attain contractual continued service status. The granting of an unpaid leave of absence (non-disability) to any non-tenured certified staff member shall not constitute a precedent for the granting or withholding of leave to any other non-tenured certified staff member. Each request shall be judged on its own merits and shall be within the sole discretion of the Board. Additional conditions or restrictions may be established for any such leave, provided nothing herein shall be construed as requiring any non-tenured certified staff member to apply for such leave or to accept the conditions established therefore.
- (9) A certified staff member granted a leave of absence hereunder shall agree as a condition precedent to waive any claim to unemployment compensation.

E. Emergency Leave

Current Sick Leave Personal Days are to be used prior to requesting Emergency Leave Days. If an emergency occurs when Personal Leave Days are not available, then the Superintendent is authorized to grant Emergency Leave days based upon necessity. In the event that previously used Personal Leave Day(s) are determined to have been used for an emergency, after all Personal Leave Days have been exhausted, additional Personal Leave Day(s) shall be granted. The granting of such leave shall not affect the salary or sick leave status of the employee.

F. Military Leave

Time necessary for personnel called into temporary active duty with any unit of the United States Reserves or the State National Guard, provided such obligations cannot be fulfilled on days when school is not in session, shall be granted. If the employee does not reimburse the District, the salary to be paid for each such day shall be computed by taking the normal daily salary and deducting therefrom the amount the employee was paid for military duty for that day.

G. Jury Duty

The employee who serves a term of jury duty shall reimburse the District the per diem amount received for jury duty (exclusive of any mileage reimbursement). The employee shall receive the full amount of his salary. This method allows for the amount of total salary listed for the Illinois Certified staff members' Retirement System not to be reduced.

If the employee does not reimburse the District, the salary to be paid for each such day shall be computed by taking the normal daily salary and deducting therefrom the amount the employee was paid for jury duty for the day.

H. Unused Sick Leave

Each certified staff member with at least five (5) years' service in the District, who is leaving the District, voluntarily or is the subject of a reduction in force, shall be paid fifty percent (50%) of the regular substitute certified staff member's daily pay for each unused Sick Leave day accumulated during the certified staff member's last five (5) years in the District. Alternatively, a certified staff member who is retiring may elect such compensation only for those days above the number the certified staff member chooses to use for ITRS service credit. Such payment shall be made no later than September 15 of that calendar year so as not to have the payment recognized as ITRS creditable earnings.

I. Family Medical Leave Act

The District shall abide by the terms of the Family Medical Leave Act.

J. District Emergency Sick Leave Bank Plan

1. Sick Leave Bank

Each new certified staff member may become a member of the Emergency Sick Leave Bank by donating one (1) sick leave day to the Bank and by submitting to the Superintendent or designee an Emergency Sick Leave Bank Enrollment form no later than September 30 of that school year. Current Certified staff members who are not members

of the Emergency Sick Leave Bank may become members by donating one (1) sick leave day to the Bank and by submitting to the Superintendent or designee an Emergency Sick Leave Bank Enrollment form no later than September 30 of that school year. Certified staff members may voluntarily donate an additional sick leave day to the Bank at any time of their choosing.

Within fourteen (14) days of a request, the Superintendent or designee shall provide to the Union President in writing an updated balance for the Emergency Sick Leave Bank inclusive of days donated by each member and a copy of each Emergency Sick Leave Bank Enrollment form submitted during that school year.

The Union President and Superintendent or designee shall be responsible for maintaining their own databases for Member certified staff member contributions and total sick leave days. At the request of either the Union President or the Superintendent or designee, the two (2) will meet periodically to compare data and confirm sick leave bank totals.

The Union shall establish an Emergency Sick Leave Bank Committee which shall be composed of the Union President and one representative certified staff member from each building and whose purpose will be to determine the dispensation of sick leave days when a request is made by a Member Certified staff member. The Union President will not have a vote unless for the purpose of breaking a tie.

2. General Conditions

If the Emergency Sick Leave Bank falls below twenty (20) days, each Member Certified staff member will again volunteer at least one (1) day in order to maintain membership in the Emergency Sick Leave Bank. Any sick day donated will be non-refundable.

Upon depletion of all their sick leave and personal leave days, a Member Certified staff member may make an application to use the Emergency Sick Leave Bank days. Emergency Sick Leave Bank days will only be approved for catastrophic illness, accident, prolonged illness, or other circumstances as determined by the Union that may affect the certified staff member.

The maximum number of days drawn by any participating Member Certified staff member shall be up to twelve (12) days per incident or a total of twelve (12) days in any one (1) school year.

3. Procedure for Use of Emergency Sick Leave Bank

Any participating Member Certified staff member will be entitled to draw from the Emergency Sick Leave Bank provided the following three (3) conditions are met:

- a. The participating Member Certified staff member has met the requirements under 2 above.
- b. The participating Member Certified staff member shall produce a Licensed Medical Doctor's certificate as proof of need to the Union president.
- c. The participating Member Certified staff member has been absent more than five (5) consecutive work days in connection with the same illness and/or incident. Exceptions such as chemotherapy treatment, renal dialysis, etc., will be approved at the discretion of the Union.

Any participating Member Certified staff member who has used the maximum number of Emergency Sick Leave Bank days will again be eligible to use the Emergency Sick Leave Bank after conditions 1-3 above are met for a second illness within the same school year. However, the five (5) day waiting period referenced in 3.c. will be waived.

If an illness carries into the next school year, conditions 1-3 must be met again before the individual is eligible to use the Emergency Sick Leave Bank again.

In cases of extreme illness (example: cancer), individual Certified staff members or school communities may approach human resources to make direct contributions a maximum of three (3) days total per school year) to directly benefit a certified staff member experiencing an extreme illness.

ARTICLE 5

SALARIES AND FRINGE BENEFITS

A. Method of Payment

Certified staff members shall be paid on the fifteenth (15th) and the thirtieth (30th) of each month. When the fifteenth (15th) or thirtieth (30th) falls on a school holiday or weekend, payroll checks shall be available on the last regular school day prior to the holiday or weekend. When the 15th or 30th falls during the winter or spring breaks payroll checks shall be available on the 15th or 30th unless those dates fall on a weekend or a holiday as noted above.

Each certified staff member who during the 2007-2008 school year received their salary in twenty (20) pay periods, (September through June), may continue to do so until such time as they elect to receive their salary in twenty-four (24) payments. Once the twenty-four (24) pay period is selected, Certified staff members may not revert to the twenty (20) pay period plan and will be paid via direct deposit only. Certified staff members employed as of the 2004-05 school year may at any time select direct deposit.

The District shall provide Certified staff members who are eligible to continue receiving their salary in twenty (20) payments with a Salary Election Form and instructions at least fifteen (15) days prior to the first day of the school year. The salary payment election shall remain in effect from year to year or until the certified staff member changes their salary payment election for a subsequent year by filing a new Salary Election Form. Certified staff members must make their salary payment election prior to the start of the first day of the school year. In no event shall the salary payment election of a certified staff member be changed after the start of the first day of the school year.

All other certified staff members shall be paid over twenty-four (24) pay periods (September through August) and via direct deposit.

1. Certified staff members are responsible for providing payroll documentation such as fringe benefits selection, state and federal withholding statements, retirement forms and Social Security data within seven (7) working days after initial employment.
2. The District shall provide each certified staff member with their salary schedule step and column placement no later than the first contractual work day of each school term.

B. Resignation

Certified staff members who resign during the school year shall be paid for the period of actual employment. The amount due the certified staff member shall be paid not more than fifteen (15) days after termination of employment.

C. Extracurricular/Supplemental Duty Pay

If the Board of Education determines that an extra-curricular/supplemental duty program is to be developed and implemented for the upcoming school year, the Board recognizes that Certified staff members shall have an opportunity to become involved in the planning of such programs. Adoption and approval of such programs shall be at the sole discretion of the Board annually. Certified staff members shall request in writing to the Superintendent or designee for approval of extracurricular/supplemental duties not listed in the chart; if approved, such approval shall be issued in writing.

Coaches and other extracurricular/supplemental duty personnel shall be paid in one (1) payment at the end of their season and/or activity upon filing a certificate of completion with the building principal.

Each school year, an Extracurricular/Supplemental Duty Committee will meet to review the following school year's positions, create job descriptions and an application process and evaluate the sustainability of the activity. The Administration retains the managerial right to create and/or remove activities, as well as approve final candidates for the activities.

Any extracurriculars/supplemental duties not listed in the Extracurricular/Supplemental Duty Pay Chart as well as any hourly events/work, including but not limited to, Saturday Detention, Saturday School, Building-Wide After School Detention Proctor, Friday Night Out Supervisors, Intramurals/Activities Supervisors, K-4 Class Supervisors for building performances, Principal Designee (as assigned), Homework Club, Newspaper, Job Alike Mentor and event work at Fine Arts/Sports Events shall be paid at the following hourly rate:

\$25.00 per hour

STIPEND	GROUPING	AMOUNT	<u># of Positions</u>	<u>Annual Application Process</u>
Dean	A	\$4,500.00	N/A	N
Wrestling	A	\$4,500.00	1 Head/2 Asst	Y
Track (GMS Boys/Girls)	B	\$4,200.00	1 Head/2 Asst	Y
Track (PC Coed)	B	\$4,200.00	1 Head/2 Asst	Y
Drama (per show, max 2 shows)	C	\$3,783.00	2	Y
Science Olympiad Coordinator	C	\$3,783.00	1	Y
Activities Director (per season, max 3 seasons)	C	\$3,783.00	1/Season	Y
Cross Country	C	\$3,783.00	1 Head/1 Asst	Y
Basketball	C	\$3,783.00	1/Team	Y
Soccer	C	\$3,783.00	1/Team	Y
Volleyball	C	\$3,783.00	1/Team	Y
Softball	C	\$3,783.00	1 Head/1 Asst	Y
School Website Coordinator	D	\$3,027.00	1/building	Y
Scholastic Bowl	D	\$3,027.00	1	Y
Cheerleading	D	\$3,027.00	1/building	Y
Dance/Poms	D	\$3,027.00	1/building	Y
Team Facilitator	D	\$3,027.00	Multiple/building	Y
Intramurals Coordinator	E	\$2,269.00	1/building	Y
Student Council (K-8)	E	\$2,269.00	1/building	Y
Band Director (Min 3 performances)	E	\$2,269.00	Per Director	N
Choral Director 5-8 (Min 3 performances)	E	\$2,269.00	Per Director	N
Board Meeting Streaming	E	\$2,269.00	1/Dist	Y
Math Club	E	\$2,269.00	1/Building	Y
Friday Night Out Coordinator	F	\$1,515.00	1/Building	Y

District Fine Arts Team Leader	F	\$1,515.00	1/ Dist	Y
Kickoff Camp (Frederick School)	F	\$1,515.00	1	Y
Yearbook	F	\$1,515.00	1	Y
Talent Show	F	\$1,515.00	1	Y
Mentor	G	\$900	Per Mentee	Y
PTO Representatives	G	\$569.00	2/Building	Y
Science Olympiad Events Coaches (maximum 8 events)	G	\$569.00	Per Event	Y

Assistant Coach or Assistant Activity Head Salary:

1st and 2nd Year: 70% of Head Coach or Activity Head
Head 3rd or More Years: 80% of Head Coach or Activity Head

D. Summer School

If the Board conducts a summer school program or extended school year (ESY), summer school and ESY Certified staff members shall receive all wages earned by June 30 in a June 30 paycheck, and the remainder of their wages on the first payday falling on or after the last day of summer school.

The hourly pay for summer school and ESY shall be Fifty Dollars (\$50.00) for the 2025-2026, 2026-2027 and 2027-2028 school years.

The Summer Coordinator position shall be paid eight thousand five-hundred twenty-two dollars (\$8522.00) for the 2025-2026, 2026-2027 and 2027-2028 school years.

The Special Programs (ESY, Pre-K) Summer coordinator position shall be paid the lesser of eight thousand five-hundred twenty-two dollars (\$8522.00) for the 2025-2026, 2026-2027 and 2027-2028 school years or an amount equal to the administrative cost limitation applicable to the grants funding the special programs. The salary amount shall be provided when the positions are posted.

If a program is canceled prior to the designated start date the Coordinator shall receive 1/3 of the stipend.

E. Term-Life Insurance

The Board shall provide each certified staff member with a fifty-thousand-dollar (\$50,000) term-life insurance policy. Certified staff members who retire or who are on leave of absence may, at their own option and upon payment of the appropriate premium, continue to be covered under the policy.

F. Fringe Benefits for Certified Staff Members Employed On or Before December 16, 2005

The Board shall make available group major medical insurance. The Board may change carrier(s), if the coverage remains substantially the same, after consulting with the Union.

1. The Board shall maintain a cafeteria plan for all certified staff members employed on or before December 16, 2005, which meets the requirements of Section 125 of the Internal Revenue Code. If, at any time, such Section 125 or related regulations are amended, the

parties shall promptly revise the plan to comply with the amendment. Each certified staff member shall have overall compensation defined as their compensation on the appended Salary Schedule(s) plus six thousand two hundred and ninety-two dollars (\$6,292). To receive the flex amount, a certified staff member must maintain the health coverage selected at the time of execution of this Agreement. Certified staff members selecting only dental insurance may elect to discontinue such coverage. Any certified staff member, who as of the 2005-06 school term has selected coverage in excess of single coverage (e.g. single + one, single + spouse, family, etc.), will continue to receive over the life of this Agreement either \$6,292 in flex or 100% HMO single and dental coverage whichever is greater.

2. A certified staff member may annually contribute any amount to the plan, not to exceed such other amount up to the limit imposed by applicable provisions of the Internal Revenue Code or Internal Revenue Service rule or regulation in any plan year. Such payments are to be deducted from the certified staff member's compensation along with deduction of contributions to the Illinois Teachers' Retirement System, which may be required on such cafeteria plan payments. Prior to the beginning day of the plan year, each certified staff member shall, in writing, designate the dollar amount(s) elected for that year for each of the following benefits:
 - a. premiums for the health, dental, disability and life insurance that is provided by the Board;
 - b. reimbursement for qualified dependent care assistance as defined in Section 129 of the Internal Revenue Code;
 - c. reimbursement for the cost of medical, dental and eye care, as defined in Section 213 of the Internal Revenue Code, to the extent not covered by insurance, and incurred by the certified staff member, the certified staff member's spouse and/or the certified staff member's dependents.
3. The amounts designated may not be changed during the plan year except if there is a change in family status or other circumstance provided by the regulations issued by the Internal Revenue Service. Any amounts designated for which valid reimbursement claims are not made on a timely basis will be forfeited and not otherwise paid to the certified staff member during that year or carried over to a succeeding plan year.
4. The dollar total of the designated fringe benefits elected pursuant to the plan will be deducted in equal amounts from the certified staff member's salary payments during the plan year unless otherwise specified.
5. Claims for reimbursement may be submitted monthly, unless the Agreement with the plan administrator provides for submission of claims on a frequency more often than monthly. Claims for reimbursement must be for services received during the plan year.
6. Part-time Certified staff members shall be eligible for full deferral of their actual additional costs pursuant to the flexible benefit plan.

G. Fringe Benefits for Certified Staff Members Employed After December 16, 2005

The Board shall provide group major medical insurance. The Board may change carrier(s), if the coverage remains substantially the same, after consulting with the Union.

1. Certified staff members shall be provided either one hundred percent (100%) Board paid single HMO medical and dental coverage or ninety-five percent (95%) Board paid single PPO medical coverage and fifty-five (55%) Board paid single PPO dental coverage. The (95%) Board paid single PPO medical coverage percentage is applied to all employee

family coverage plans including spouse and employee with child(ren), offered by the district as well.

2. A certified staff member may annually contribute any amount to the plan, not to exceed such other amount up to the limit imposed by applicable provisions of the Internal Revenue Code or Internal Revenue Service rule or regulation in any plan year. Such payments are to be deducted from the certified staff member's compensation along with deduction of contributions to the Illinois Teachers' Retirement System, which may be required on such cafeteria plan payments. Prior to the beginning day of the plan year, each certified staff member shall, in writing, designate the dollar amount(s) elected for that year for each of the following benefits:
 - a. premiums for the health, dental, disability and life insurance that exceed those provided by the Board;
 - b. reimbursement for qualified dependent care assistance as defined in Section 129 of the Internal Revenue Code;
 - c. reimbursement for the cost of medical, dental and eye care, as defined in Section 213 of the Internal Revenue Code, to the extent not covered by insurance, and incurred by the certified staff member, the certified staff member's spouse and/or the certified staff member's dependents.
3. The amounts designated may not be changed during the plan year except if there is a change in family status or other circumstance provided by the regulations issued by the Internal Revenue Service. Any amounts designated for which valid reimbursement claims are not made on a timely basis will be forfeited and not otherwise paid to the certified staff member during that year or carried over to a succeeding plan year.
4. The dollar total of the designated fringe benefits elected pursuant to the plan will be deducted in equal amounts from the certified staff member's salary payments during the plan year unless otherwise specified.
5. Claims for reimbursement may be submitted monthly, unless the Agreement with the plan administrator provides for submission of claims on a frequency more often than monthly. Claims for reimbursement must be for services received during the plan year.
6. Part-time certified staff members shall be eligible for full deferral of their actual additional costs pursuant to the flexible benefit plan.

H. Personal Injury and Liability Insurance

A certified staff member who is absent from school as a result of a personal injury arising out of and in the course of their employment and who receives Workers Compensation benefit payments may elect to receive one third (1/3) of their regular pay in addition to any Worker's Compensation payments received by the certified staff member. In the event of such an election, the certified staff member will be charged one third (1/3) of a sick leave day for each day of absence while on Workers Compensation leave. Once a certified staff member who has not submitted their notice of intent to retire exhausts accumulated sick leave days, they will no longer receive any payments of salary from the Board after the termination of Worker's Compensation leave. A certified staff member who has submitted their notice of intent to retire and who has exhausted their sick leave will continue to receive the payment of one third (1/3) of their salary from the Board until the termination of Worker's Compensation leave or the effective date of retirement, whichever is sooner.

I. Tuition Reimbursement

The Board shall reimburse the cost of graduate course tuition, including all required textbook fees, up to two thousand two hundred sixty-six dollars (\$2,266) per certified staff member per school year and not to exceed one hundred ten thousand dollars (\$110,000) per school year. In the event, the yearly amount budgeted for professional growth is exceeded by claims, the following calculation will serve to determine the percentage reimbursement per certified staff member's total claim.

(appropriate yearly amount) /total professional growth dollar claims = _____%

Multiply the percentage calculated above by each certified staff member's total claim amount.

Individual courses to be taken for credit leading to a salary adjustment should be pre-approved by the Superintendent or designee unless the person was in a pre-approved course of study which would lead to a graduate degree in an educational field of study or a field of study related to the certified staff member's assignment and/or responsibilities with the District in which case it is understood all courses related to the graduate degree are approved.

A salary adjustment for professional growth will be given for coursework pre-approved by the Superintendent or designee according to the following limitations:

1. Up to thirty two (32) semester hours beyond the Bachelor's Degree, or completion of a Master's Degree, whichever comes first.
2. Up to thirty two (32) semester hours beyond the Master's Degree, or completion of a Doctoral Degree, whichever comes first.
3. Coursework (hours) earned prior to the implementation of the 1984-85 Agreement shall not be included in the thirty two (32) hours.
4. Other than Pass/Fail courses, all graduate hours receiving a grade of "B" or better shall be approved for a salary adjustment; Pass/Fail course(s) must receive a grade of "Pass."
5. Any certified staff member taking graduate coursework in a recognized institution of higher learning shall have the use of the District copier, at no charge, to copy a paper that is original to the certified staff member.
6. Certified staff members must submit a transcript or grade card no later than September 15 of a school year to receive reimbursement for any coursework which concludes on or before August 31 of that school year. Reimbursement shall be issued by the first pay check date in October.

Certified staff members must submit a transcript or grade card no later than January 15 of a school year to receive reimbursement for any coursework which concludes on or before December 31 of that school year. Reimbursement shall be issued by the first pay check date in February.

7. Tuition reimbursement shall only occur if classes are taken from the list of approved colleges and universities, as determined by the Superintendent or designee. The list will be updated at the beginning of the school year and may be obtained from the district office.

J. Graduate Credit Leading to a Salary Adjustment Increase

1. Individual courses to be taken for credit leading to a salary adjustment must be pre-approved by the Superintendent or designee unless the person was in a pre-approved

course of study which would lead to a graduate degree in an educational field of study or a field of study related to the certified staff member's assignment and/or responsibilities with the District in which case it is understood all courses related to the graduate degree are approved. Other than Pass/Fail courses, all graduate hours receiving a grade of "B" or better shall be approved for a salary adjustment; Pass/Fail course(s) must receive a grade of "Pass."

2. Coursework taken which allows for official transcripts to be received at the District Administrative Office on or before September 30th shall allow for a salary adjustment for the entire year, effective the final pay period in October. The Superintendent or designee may at their discretion allow a certified staff member to provide alternate proof of an official transcript temporarily in the event the educational institution is unable to provide an official copy of the transcript on or before September 30th.
3. Coursework taken which allows for official transcripts to be received at the District Administrative Office after September 30th, but on or before January 30th of any school year, shall allow for a salary adjustment to be one-half (1/2) the new step and lane placement, effective the first (1st) pay period in February. The Superintendent or designee may at their discretion allow a certified staff member to provide alternate proof of an official transcript temporarily in the event the educational institution is unable to provide an official copy of the transcript on or before January 30th. The following school year the individual will receive the increase in the new academic column.
4. Certified staff members on the salary schedule shall receive a salary adjustment set forth in the salary schedule in Appendix A. Certified staff members who have surpassed the maximum step of the salary schedule (step 20) and are in the longevity tier shall be eligible for an education lane advancement increase as follows: two percent (2%) each for attaining graduate credit levels of BA+8, BA+16, BA+24, BA+32, four percent (4%) for attaining graduate credit MA, three percent (3%) each for attaining graduate credit levels of MA+8, MA+16, MA+24, and eight percent (8%) for attaining the graduate credit level of MA+32. October increases will be added to the current annual base salary. February lane changes will receive the full adjustment prorated beginning in February.
5. Each certified staff member shall be allowed no more than one (1) salary adjustment during each school year. If a certified staff member earns enough credits for more than one (1) salary adjustment in any school year, the certified staff member shall receive a salary adjustment at the earliest opportunity, but in no event more than one (1) salary adjustment per school year. However, a certified staff member who earns a Master's Degree shall receive a salary adjustment(s) commensurate to that of a Master's Degree at the earliest opportunity provided in Paragraphs 1 and 2.
6. A salary adjustment shall only occur if classes are taken from the list of approved colleges and universities, as determined by the Superintendent or designee. The list will be updated at the beginning of the school year and may be obtained from the district office.

K. Conferences, Workshops and Meetings, and Administrative Academies

1. Requests for Professional Leave for conferences, workshops, meetings, and administrative academies must be made at least ten (10) days in advance of the event whenever possible.
2. The Superintendent or designee shall approve or disapprove within three (3) business days following receipt of that form.
3. Salary of substitute certified staff member shall be assumed by the Board.

4. Travel shall be reimbursed at the rate established by the Board of Education annually. Meals shall be reimbursed in full in accordance with Board expense reimbursement policy. The Board will not pay for registration fees for administrator academies.
5. The certified staff member shall be reimbursed on the next regularly scheduled payday following the next regularly scheduled meeting of the Board of Education.

L. Outside Experience

The following shall be the formula for credit for Certified staff members new to the District:

1. Each certified staff member new to the District shall be granted a number of years of credit no greater than their actual years of service.
2. Any newly hired or rehired Certified staff members may receive up to a maximum of twelve (12) years of prior relevant teaching experience (For example: 12 years of prior experience would start the new Certified staff member on step 13 of the salary schedule) at the discretion of the Director of Human Resources or Designee. Relevant teaching experience includes full or part time teaching in a public or private K-12 accredited school requiring a PEL or equivalent for experience outside of Illinois. Certified staff members shall submit documentation of prior teaching experience within sixty (60) calendar days of hire to confirm placement on the salary schedule. No adjustments to initial placement will be made after sixty (60) calendar days. Initial placement on the salary schedule within the first 13 steps may result in a new certified staff member's salary exceeding those of certified staff members already employed by the District.
3. In order to assist the District with attracting and retaining the highest quality staff members for all positions in the District, candidates applying for "hard to fill" positions can be given credit for up to a maximum of sixteen (16) years of actual previous experience (example: 16 years of experience would be given, and the new hire would start on step 17). The Union and Administration will agree on "hard to fill" positions on an as needed and ongoing basis. Whenever possible, the Administration will alert the Union to anticipated "hard to fill" positions in the spring. Initial placement on the salary schedule for "hard to fill" positions that have been agreed to by the Administration and Union may result in a new certified staff member's salary exceeding those of certified staff members already employed by the District.
4. In times of extraordinary market conditions, the Board may grant up to two (2) new certified staff member(s) per school year a one time signing bonus of up to ten percent (10%) of the new certified staff member's actual starting salary.
5. Prior to the final starting salary determination, the Superintendent or designee will advise the Union President or designee of the anticipated starting salary of the new certified staff member. Afterwards, the salary for the new certified staff member, while following the above language, will be at the sole discretion of the Superintendent or designee. Within ten (10) business days of the certified staff member's start date, the Union President will receive notice of the new certified staff member's actual starting salary.

M. Mileage Reimbursement

Certified staff members shall be paid at the mileage rate established by the Internal Revenue Service to perform duties within and without the School District, provided such duties have been pre- approved by the Superintendent or designee.

N. Contribution to TRS

The Board shall remit for each certified staff member the full amount allowable by law to the Certified staff members' Retirement System (TRS) to be applied to the account of such certified staff member. Any amount due the TRS shall be deducted from the certified staff member's salary and remitted to TRS by the District.

The Board shall remit for each certified staff member the required fifty-eight one hundredths of one percent (0.58%) to the Certified staff members' Retirement System (TRS) for payment of Certified staff members Retirement System Health Insurance. The Board shall also remit the first eighty-four one hundredths (0.84%) percentage points of the certified staff member portion of the THIS contribution. This amount due TRS shall be paid by the Board above and beyond any other compensation due each certified staff member and shall not be deducted from the certified staff member's salary.

O. Salary/Longevity Increase/Tenure Bonus

1. Certified staff members shall be paid pursuant to their placement on the Salary Schedule(s) as provided in Appendix A. Certified staff members will be notified of their placement no later than August 1, 2025 for the 2025-2026 school year. Each subsequent contract year, Certified staff members will be notified of their placement and salary no later than the first contractual work day of each school term.
2. For Certified staff members who have surpassed the final cell in their educational level column, the District will provide a longevity increase as follows:

2025-2026:	3.0%
2026-2027:	3.5%
2027-2028:	3.0%

For the duration of this Agreement, the District will provide each certified staff member who is eligible for longevity, an increase of \$1,250.00 annually which shall be added to the salary prior to that school year's annual percentage increase.

For illustrative purposes:

2024-2025 Salary:	\$50,000
2025-2026 Longevity Increase:	\$ 1,250
2025-2026 Salary:	\$51,250
Total 2025-2026 %:	3.0%
Total 2025-2026 Salary:	\$52,788

2025-2026 Salary:	\$52,788
2026-2027 Longevity Increase:	\$ 1,250
2026-2027 Salary:	\$54,038
Total 2026-2027 %:	3.5%
Total 2026-2027 Salary:	\$55,929

2026-2027 Salary:	\$55,929
2027-2028 Longevity Increase:	\$ 1,250
2027-2028 Salary:	\$57,179
Total 2027-2028 %:	3.0%
Total 2027-2028 Salary:	\$58,894

3. For the duration of this Agreement, each Certified staff member who achieves tenure with the District shall receive a one-time, non-recurring, non-compounding bonus of Three Thousand Dollars (\$3,000.00). The bonus will be disbursed no later than the September

30th payroll of the following school term. This does not apply to any individual certified staff member who received tenure prior to the 2025-2026 school year.

4. During the 2025-2026 school year, a Salary Schedule Committee will be established to collaboratively study, develop, and recommend a revised salary schedule that is indexed-based. An index-based salary schedule is a compensation structure in which each salary cell is determined by applying a mathematical index to a designated base salary. The schedule uses a system of horizontal steps (education) and vertical steps with each cell representing a percentage or multiplier of the base salary.

The committee shall be composed of District and Union representation, with each party selecting its own representatives. The committee will meet regularly during the term of the contract and will aim to produce a recommendation prior to expiration of the contract, with the intent that any agreed-upon changes may be considered for inclusion in future collective bargaining agreements. Recommendations from the committee shall be advisory in nature and subject to the collective bargaining process.

P. Retirement Options

1. To be eligible for this incentive, Certified staff members at the date of retirement must:
 - a. have served a minimum of ten (10) years of teaching in the District (excluding time on unpaid leave of absence), AND
 - b. have attained whatever requirements may be necessary under Illinois Pension Code to qualify as a TRS retiree and eliminate any employer paid retirement penalty on behalf of the certified staff member except as outlined in subparagraph (2) below regarding exceeding six percent (6%).

For up to the last four (4) years of the eligible certified staff member's employment, the certified staff member shall receive a 6% increase in their base salary over the base salary of the preceding year.

Eligible Certified staff members applying for this incentive must submit an irrevocable written notice to the Superintendent or designee on or before March 1 of the school term of the year prior to the first year in which the certified staff member expects a six percent (6%) increase in their base salary. For Certified staff member(s) who submitted an irrevocable written notice to the Superintendent or designee and who is/are currently receiving this retirement incentive, they may extend their retirement date by one (1) year provided notice is given to the Superintendent and/or designee no later than August 31, 2025. Any Certified staff member who would like to submit retirement under this section as revised for the 2025-2028 Agreement may submit an intent to retire letter no later than August 31, 2025.

A certified staff member may petition the Board to rescind their notice of retirement, which may be approved or refused by the Board within its sole discretion and which decision may not be challenged through the grievance procedure. In the event the Board agrees to the rescission of the retirement notice, the certified staff member must agree to repay the amount of the retirement incentive paid by the Board, which may include execution of a promissory note to secure repayment.

PROMISSORY NOTE

I, _____, assert and promise as follows:

If the Board approves a request to rescind or postpone my retirement date, then for value received, I promise to pay to the order of the Board of Education of Community Consolidated School District #46, the total sum of all amounts (including withholding and other taxes) added to my compensation by the Board of Education of Community Consolidated School District #46 as a consequence of my having elected retirement pursuant to Article 5.P. of the Collective Bargaining Agreement in effect between said Board of Education and the Grayslake Federation of Certified staff members of the Lake County Federation of Certified staff members, Local 504, IFT-AFT/AFL-CIO. Such payment shall be made no later than my final day of service with Community Consolidated School District #46. Furthermore, it is understood I may later submit for a new District Retirement incentive to coordinate with my new retirement date.

I agree that should I default in the above referenced payment, I hereby waive any notice of default and service of process and confess to a judgment that may be entered against me in a court of competent jurisdiction. I further agree that in the event of a default of this agreement, I will pay all costs and fees (including attorney's fees) incurred by the Board of Education of Community Consolidated School District #46 in collecting the balance due.

Signed

Date

WITNESS

Date

WITNESS

Date

A certified staff member who gives written notice of retirement shall within their last four (4) years of employment be entitled to additional extracurricular duties if pay for such does not exceed a six percent (6%) increase in total creditable earnings over the creditable earnings reported to the Illinois Certified staff members Retirement System in the previous school year. The District and Certified staff member shall work together to monitor all creditable earnings (including but not limited to extra duties and/or stipend pay) to ensure that the Certified staff member does not exceed a 6% increase to creditable earnings in any given year. At the time of notification of retirement, extra dut(ies) that have been performed and continue to be performed will be part of the Certified staff member's creditable earnings. However, if a reassignment and/or the Certified staff member chooses not to perform the extra duty, in order to maintain creditable earnings, the Parties will work together to find other creditable duties, if possible. Extra duties and/or stipends performed by a Certified staff member in the retirement track at the request of a District Administrator or Supervisor that causes the District to incur a TRS penalty shall not penalize the Certified staff member performing the duties or be charged to the Certified staff member in the form of a monetary penalty

2. Certified staff members taking the retirement option according to Board of Education established policy, shall be able to continue their participation in the District health insurance program until age sixty-five (65). Continuation of this participation is contingent on the premiums for this health insurance coverage being paid by the retired employee according to the current rates established by the carrier.
3. Certified staff members taking the retirement option shall also receive pay for fifty percent (50%) of any sick leave above the three hundred forty (340) days accepted by TRS at their per diem rate.

Q. Substitute Pay

Any certified staff member who substitutes for another class during their preparation period shall receive compensation per fifty (50)-minute period or fraction thereof at the rate of \$23.17.

Any certified staff member who substitutes for a day, series of days, or long term for another position while being required to continue their work responsibilities for their regularly assigned position shall receive compensation per fifty (50)-minute period or fraction thereof per period at the rate of \$23.17

Certified staff members of Early Childhood and MILE/LINK classes not receiving a substitute for any absent paraprofessional shall receive compensation at the daily initial substitute rate established by the District after three (3) consecutive school days without coverage. The Parties agree that this does not apply to a one-to-one paraprofessional who is absent from the classroom for any reason if their assigned student is also absent. In classrooms where multiple paraprofessionals are absent, each absence shall count as one (1) consecutive day.

For example:

<u>Absence</u>	<u>Days Absent</u>	<u>Payment</u>
Single Paraprofessional	3 (i.e. Monday, Tuesday Wednesday)	1 day of sub pay (i.e. still absent on Thursday)
Two Paraprofessionals (i.e. 2 on Monday, 2 on Tuesday and 1 returns on Wednesday)	2 (i.e. Monday and Tuesday)	1 day of sub pay
Three Paraprofessionals	1 (i.e. all three on Monday)	1 day of sub pay if one of the 2 are still absent on the second day

R. National Board Certification

The Board shall provide a one-time stipend of five thousand dollars (\$5,000) upon receipt of the certification earned for Certified staff members by the National Board of Professional Teaching Standards (NBPTS).

S. PBIS Stipend

Stipends will be paid for PBIS positions at each building. Frederick School, Park School, and the Middle School shall each receive four thousand dollars (\$4000) per school year; Avon School, Meadowview School, Prairieview School, and Woodview School shall each receive two thousand dollars (\$2000) per school year. The Superintendent or designee, in consultation with the principals and the Director of Pupil Services, shall determine the distribution of PBIS stipend money at each school.

T. Transcripts

Upon initial hire, a certified staff member will substantiate their education level by submitting official transcripts in a sealed envelope, or by electronic transcript, from the appropriate educational institution(s) to the District business office. If the certified staff member is hired prior to the first day of certified staff member duty in the school term, the transcript must be received by the District business office by September 30. If the certified staff member is hired after the first day of certified staff member duty in the school term, the transcripts must be received by the District business office within thirty (30) calendar days of the certified staff member's first day of work. Failure to submit the official transcripts will result in the adjustment of the certified staff member's salary based on the appropriate, substantiated level of education until such time as official transcripts are provided. Once official transcripts are provided, and after consulting with the Union President, the certified staff member's corrected salary will be determined. To be entitled to a re-adjusted salary and retroactive pay, the certified staff member must submit their official transcripts within thirty (30) calendar days after the original deadline for submission of such official transcript(s), otherwise, the certified staff member will be entitled only to a re-adjustment of salary effective the first (1st) pay period of the following school year.

ARTICLE 6 WORKING CONDITIONS

A. Safety and Cleanliness

The Board shall provide safe and sanitary working conditions for all Certified staff members within the fiscal capabilities of the District. The Administration shall provide continuous monitoring of working conditions and shall correct unsafe and/or unsanitary conditions provided that these conditions are under the jurisdiction of the Administration. The certified staff member should report a maintenance ticket for any unsafe or unsanitary conditions to the building principal. Such report may be in the form of a work order request, a written note, or by e-mail.

Annually, the Union President or designee and the Director of Operations, Maintenance, and Safety shall walk through each building. In addition, the Union President or designee shall be included during the annual ROE safety walk through and be provided a copy of the issued report.

B. Student Discipline

As a part of these working conditions, the Board recognizes the inherent responsibility of the instructional teaching staff to establish and maintain student discipline and supervision according to Board policies. The Board shall support the certified staff member in the specific implementation of such policies.

Certified staff members who have specific concerns about their safety should first bring their concerns to a building administrator. If concerns are not resolved at that level, they may request a meeting with the Superintendent or designee.

C. School Day Defined

The Board shall adjust the start and close of the school day according to the student needs, provided that the school day does not exceed seven and one-half (7-1/2) clock hours, inclusive of an average of at least a forty (40) minute duty free lunch period.

D. Student Recess

Certified staff members shall not be responsible for the supervision of students during any District scheduled student recess or lunch period.

E. Job Share Provisions

A tenured certified staff member interested in sharing a single certified staff member position with another qualified certified staff member may submit a written proposal to the Superintendent or designee ("Job Share"). All Job Share proposals must be submitted on or before March 1 to be eligible for the following school year in which the proposed job sharing would occur, except that the Superintendent or designee at their sole discretion may accept for consideration proposals submitted after March 1st. The tenured certified staff member initiating such a proposal shall be responsible for identifying the qualified certified staff member with whom a certified staff member assignment would be divided. In the event the District interviews and hires a job share certified staff member, the tenured certified staff member shall be included in the process. Job Share shall be considered as each certified staff member working one-half (0.5) day assignments.

Approval of a Job Share proposal shall be at the discretion of the Superintendent or designee, and the granting or denying of such a proposal shall neither be grievable nor create a practice or precedent. In considering a Job Share proposal, the Superintendent or designee shall establish the criteria and qualifications (i.e., experience, educational background), which the candidate for a particular job-sharing assignment must hold. In addition, the Superintendent or designee shall interview each job share candidate. There shall be no guaranteed minimum number of such job-sharing assignments granted each year. When assuming a Job Share assignment, both certified staff members must mutually agree to the following terms:

- (a) Job Share certified staff members shall both agree to attend and participate in the District's full day program of staff development, certified staff member in-service and institute Day activities;
- (b) Staffing and faculty meetings shall be attended by both Job Share certified staff members on their scheduled workdays only;
- (c) The overall instructional schedule and academic program will not be adjusted to accommodate the needs of Job Share certified staff members;
- (d) Job Share certified staff members shall each agree to assume responsibility for communicating with one another regarding instruction, student needs and all other matters related to the job share assignment; and
- (e) Job Share certified staff members shall both agree to attend all parent conferences and to participate in After School Extra Duties according to Article 5, Section I of the Collective Bargaining Agreement.
- (f) Job Share certified staff members who move to a full-time position shall be given one-half (1/2) of a year's experience credit for each of their in-district Job Share years when determining their new full-time salary.

Seniority credit for Job Share certified staff members will be one-half year per school year. Tenure rights and any accrued seniority will not be affected as a result of sharing a teaching position. Each Job Share certified staff member shall be paid fifty percent (50%) of their own full-time salary. Each year Job Share certified staff members shall receive the same percentage increase as full time certified staff members. All fringe benefits and insurance benefits for Job Share certified staff members shall be prorated, subject to the provisions of the insurance benefits then in effect.

Job Share assignments, when granted, shall be for a maximum of one year. Extensions for an additional year may be requested on or before March 1, for the following school year, but such requests shall not be automatic for approval and is subject to the sole discretion of the Superintendent or designee.

F. Meetings

Pre-kindergarten through fourth grade certified staff members shall have no more than two (2) regularly scheduled meeting(s) per week, scheduled by Administrators, Deans, the EC Coordinator, TOSA, or Instructional Coaches, which shall occur during non-student contact time (before or after the student day) within the certified staff member's contractual work day unless meetings are initiative or emergency in nature, or meetings of committees established pursuant to this Agreement. An occasional third meeting may be added by Administration after consultation with the Union President or designee. It is not the intent of the Parties to add a third meeting at the pre-kindergarten through fourth grade level on a weekly basis.

Fifth through eighth grade certified staff members shall have no more than four (4) meetings per week, scheduled by Administrators, Deans, TOSA, or Instructional Coaches, which shall

occur during non-student contact time (before or after the student day) within the certified staff member's contractual work day unless meetings are initiative or emergency in nature, or meetings of committees established pursuant to this Agreement.

Any meetings which require work/preparation outside the meeting time may only occur after express agreement between the Union president and the Superintendent or designee.

There shall be no group meetings during report card weeks, (first week of following term), progress report weeks, and parent-teacher conference weeks. Any meetings which require work/preparation outside the meeting time may only occur after express agreement between the Union president and the Superintendent or designee. "No Meetings Week" dates shall be included and updated each school year in the Employee Handbook and building calendars where available by administration and staff. Meetings related to the following are not allowed:

- PLC/Team meetings
- SST/PST meetings
- Staff meetings
- Data meetings
- Post-Observation Evaluation meetings
- Formal Observations
- Evening programs
- Fine arts programs

Meetings related to the following are acceptable during a "No Meetings Week":

- Discipline meetings
- Parent/Guardian meetings
- Pre-observation meetings
- IEP/504 meetings
- PDTs (professional development during student contact time)
- Emergency meetings
- Afterschool events (i.e: coaching a sport) for which staff members are paid

If the evaluation observation timeline is interrupted by a "No Meetings Week", the District and Union agree that the timeline shall be suspended for "No Meetings Week" and resume the following week (i.e: Formal Post observation written evaluation is due no later than the Wednesday of "No Meetings Week". The Union and District agree that the timeline in this circumstance will be extended to the next Wednesday).

G. Committee Appointments

Unless otherwise noted in this Agreement, certified staff appointed to standing committees covered under this Agreement or District Committees related to hours, wages or working conditions for the Grayslake Federation of Teachers, shall be chosen by the Union President, after discussion with the Superintendent or designee. The Union President shall seek volunteers before the discussion with the Superintendent or designee. The District shall notify the Union President of the committee, anticipated meeting date, and number or type of member(s) needed to fill committee positions. After the discussion, the Union President shall provide names for the committee one (1) week prior to the first meeting.

H. Resources, Technology and Training

Within the reasonable efforts of the District staff, technology and classroom resources shall be available and working by the second (2nd) certified staff member contract day. In the event a District building is unable to provide adequate resources or technology for certified staff members to complete their assigned work due to building-wide technological difficulties during the school day, a minimum of one (1) additional day will be allotted to complete said assigned

work with no less than one (1) day allotted for each day or portion thereof for technology system difficulties.

I. Certified Staff Member Mentoring Program

The Union and the District will work together each spring to review the existing program, consider feedback from mentors and mentees and make changes for the upcoming school term. A handbook will be produced annually for use with the program participants that outlines the responsibilities and expectations for all participants: mentors, mentees, program leaders and administration. Every effort will be made to limit each mentor to two (2) mentees. The stipend amount for mentors shall be paid per mentee assigned. If the District must assign a third or fourth mentee to a mentor, it shall be by mutual agreement with the mentor and the Union President shall be notified. Every effort shall be made so that mentors assigned to mentees shall be from similar disciplines or grade level of pre-K through 4th grade. Mentors and mentees will be given one (1) release day per trimester, though not necessarily the same release day for all pairs, to collaborate and work together.

Mentor training dates and times scheduled prior to mentee assignments shall be set annually in consultation with Union leadership.

J. After School Extra Duties

All certified staff members shall participate in Back to School Supply Drop Off, Back to School Night and school-wide conference days. Certified staff members may voluntarily participate in extra duties after school including, but not limited to, Open House, Family Nights, Reading Nights, Curriculum Nights, graduation, and PTO Meetings. Back to School Supply Drop Off shall be scheduled for 1 ½ hours on the morning of the second institute day prior to the first student attendance day unless otherwise agreed to by the Superintendent and Union President.

I. Scheduling and Plan Time – Joint Labor/Management Committees

The Parties agree that two (2) joint scheduling committees, i.e., one (1) at the elementary level and one (1) at the middle school level, shall be established by the Parties each year.

The committees shall function as advisory committees and shall each be composed of up to six (6) members appointed by the Administration and up to six (6) members appointed by the Union. The committees shall meet a minimum of three (3) times per year between February and August to discuss issues related to plan time and upcoming schedules.

The Parties also agree that the committees will have the opportunity to discuss, brainstorm and exchange meaningful ideas that may improve plan time for Certified staff members, the educational experience for students and the operations of the District.

Plan time is defined as time set aside for educational related responsibility as may be determined by the Superintendent or designee to include, but not be limited to, planning classroom lessons, classroom preparation, attending professional meetings with supervisors, colleagues, parents, or students, completing professional phone calls, etc. Plan time for part-time employees shall be determined on a prorated basis.

Plan time shall generally be a continuous block of time of not less than thirty (30) consecutive minutes outside the duty-free lunch, and during the student attendance portion of the school day, provided the student attendance is not shortened. Within the financial ability of the School District, the Board of Education will make a diligent effort to provide a minimum of one (1) plan time per day.

Planning time for Certified staff members of at least two hundred twenty-five (225) minutes in each five (5) day week. Time before and after student attendance time may be used to meet the total.

J. Class Size

Academic classes for Kindergarten through 4th grade will not exceed twenty-five (25) students per class. Specials classes for Kindergarten through 4th grade will not exceed thirty (30) students per class. Academic classes for 5th through 8th grade will not exceed thirty (30) students per class. Specials classes for 5th through 8th grade students will not exceed thirty-five (35) students per class.

For the duration of this contract, the District will reduce the number of students “not to exceed” for Kindergarten through 2nd grade by one (1) student per year ending with twenty-two (22) students per class in 2027-2028.

Year	K-2nd grade class size
2025-2026	Not to exceed 24
2026-2027	Not to exceed 23
2027-2028	Not to exceed 22

If class sizes are exceeded one of two options below will be executed:

- A program assistant will be added to the class specifically for the overage purpose. Program assistants already assigned to the class for other purposes do not count for this instance.

OR

- Pay the certified staff member a stipend as follows:

	<u>Per Trimester</u>	<u>Per Year</u>
Per Class	\$350.00	\$1,050.00
Full Day	\$1,000.00	\$3,000.00

Where administratively possible, if a MILE or LINK Classroom has a paraprofessional assigned to them for academic classes, the same number of paraprofessionals will also be assigned to attend specials classes with the class or student.

K. Special Education

1. Certified staff members will adhere to District and legal timelines and procedures when completing special education paperwork and reports.
2. Applicable certified staff members will be provided training on paperwork and reporting necessary to complete District and State related paperwork and reports. Applicable certified staff will receive training on instructional best practices. These trainings may be provided in person and/or electronically.

3. If an applicable certified staff member would like in-person training, they will reach out to the Student Services Director to make arrangements for in-person training, which will be provided if feasible.
4. The Superintendent or designee may exempt special educators, including early childhood Certified staff members and multilingual Certified staff members, from general PD or training not relevant to them to provide additional release time to complete paperwork or other specific training.
5. Where administratively possible, Special Education Certified staff members shall not provide resource services to more than three grade levels or be the certified staff member of record for more than three subject/content areas in 5-8th grade in a given school year. However, it is possible that a student could have goals that can be addressed through multiple subject areas, in which case a certified staff member may provide services during various classes.
6. A Workload/Caseload Committee will meet once per trimester in order to discuss areas of effectiveness and ideas for addressing workload concerns. The Committee will consist of Administration, the Union President or Designee, and six (6) special educators, three (3) of whom must be special education facilitators, who will be chosen by the Union after discussion with the Superintendent or Designee. If a meeting is not needed, the District and Union can agree to cancel the meeting.

L. Exit Interviews

Exit interviews will be offered to all certified staff members leaving the District for any reason including retirement. Exit interviews will be conducted by the Director of Human Resources. Upon employee written request this interview may be conducted with the Union President or Designee present.

M. Absenteeism and Burnout Study

During the course of this Agreement, the Union President and the Director of Human Resources shall meet to identify ways to support certified staff member mental health and wellbeing to improve absenteeism and job burn out among the teaching staff.

ARTICLE 7 GRIEVANCE PROCEDURE

A. Definition

A grievance shall mean a complaint that there has been an alleged breach, misinterpretation, or inequitable administration of any provision of this Agreement.

B. Statement of Basic Principles

1. Every certified staff member shall have the right to present grievances in accordance with these procedures, with or without representation of the Union. Nothing contained in this Article or elsewhere in this Agreement shall be construed to prevent any individual employee from discussing a problem with the Board and having it adjusted without intervention of or representation by the Union. A grievance may also be filed by a Union representative in the name of the Grayslake Federation of Certified staff members.
2. The failure of a certified staff member or the Union to act on any grievance within the prescribed time limits shall act as a bar to any further appeal and the Board's failure to give a decision within the time limits shall permit the grievant to proceed to the next step. The time limits, however, may be extended by mutual agreement. The Union may initiate a grievance at Step 2 or Step 3 if the matter involves more than one program or school or the matter involves a policy covering the District or more than one school.
3. Any certified staff member has a right to be represented by the Union in the grievance procedure. The certified staff member shall be present at any grievance discussion when the Union or Board deems it necessary. When the presence of a certified staff member at a grievance hearing is requested by either party, illness or other incapacity of the certified staff member shall be grounds for any necessary extension of grievance procedure time limits.
4. In any instance where the Union is not represented in the grievance procedure after Step One, the Union shall be notified of the final disposition of the grievance. Any final disposition of grievance alleged by the Union to be in conflict with the Agreement shall be grievable by the Union.
5. Hearings and conferences under this procedure shall be conducted at a time and place which shall afford a fair and reasonable opportunity to all persons, and shall be held, insofar as possible, after regular school hours, or during non-teaching time of personnel involved. When such hearings and conferences are held at the option of the board during school hours, all employees whose presence is required shall be excused with pay for that purpose.
6. It is agreed that any investigation or other handling or processing of any grievance by the grieving certified staff member or Union representatives shall be conducted so as to result in no interference with or interruption whatsoever of the instructional program and related work activities of the teaching staff.
7. All time limits consist of school days except that when a grievance is submitted on or after May 31, of any time limits shall consist of all weekdays so that the matters may be resolved before the close of the school term or as soon as possible thereafter. School days, for the purpose of the grievance procedure, shall mean certified staff member employment days. If the final day of any time limit falls on a holiday, then the time limit will be extended to include the next school day (or week day, as applicable).

C. Procedures

1. **First Step**: An attempt shall be made to resolve any grievance in informal, verbal discussion between complainant and their immediate supervisor.
2. **Second Step**: If the grievance cannot be resolved informally, the aggrieved certified staff member shall file the grievance in writing and at a mutually agreeable time, discuss the matter with the Principal. The written grievance should state the nature of the grievance, should note the specific clause or clauses of the Agreement allegedly violated, and should state the remedy requested. The filing of the grievance at the Second Step must be within twenty (20) school days from the date of the occurrence of the event giving rise to the grievance. The Principal or other Administrator who has authority to make a decision on the grievance shall make such decision and communicate it in writing to the certified staff member and the Superintendent or designee within fifteen (15) school days.
3. **Third Step**: In the event a grievance has not been satisfactorily resolved at the Second Step, the aggrieved certified staff member shall file, within five (5) school days of the Principal's written decision or answer at the Second Step, a copy of the grievance with the Superintendent or designee. Within ten (10) school days after such written grievance is filed, the aggrieved, representative of the aggrieved as desired, the Principal and the Superintendent or designee shall meet to resolve the grievance. The Superintendent or designee, shall file an answer within ten (10) school days of the Third Step grievance meeting and communicate it in writing to the certified staff member, the Principal and the Union.
4. **Fourth Step**: The Union may appeal the response in the Third Step, above, by submitting to the Superintendent or designee, a demand in writing within fifteen (15) school days of such response that the matter be advanced to final and binding arbitration in accordance with the rules set forth below. The cost of the arbitrator shall be shared equally by the Board and the Union. The Federal Mediation and Conciliation Service (FMCS) will administer the arbitration proceedings.

D. Rules for Arbitration

1. Briefs, if required, shall be due within thirty (30) calendar days of the completion of the hearing. Briefs shall be submitted in duplicate directly to the arbitrator, who upon receipt of both briefs shall transmit one (1) copy to each party.
2. The arbitrator's decision shall be due within thirty (30) calendar days of their receipt of both briefs, or, if no briefs are required, within thirty (30) calendar days of the close of the hearing.

ARTICLE 8

DURATION AND TECHNICAL CLAUSES

A. Duration of Agreement

This Agreement shall be in effect as of July 1, 2025 and shall continue in full force and effect until June 30, 2028. The ending date shall not be construed to deprive certified staff members of earned benefits; neither shall it preclude a grievance from being resolved on its merits when such grievance has not run its full course by that date. If a summer school program is announced by the Board of Education, this Agreement will automatically be extended to cover those time periods.

B. Technical Clauses

Separability - In the event any provision of this Agreement is or shall at any time be contrary to law, all other provisions of this Agreement shall continue in effect.

C. No Strike Clause

The Union shall not strike during the life of this Agreement.

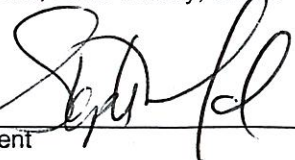
D. Typing and Publishing of the Agreement

The Union shall assume responsibility and cost related to the typing of this Agreement for execution by the parties. The Board shall publish the Agreement on the staff page of the School District website and provide certified staff members with a printed copy of the Agreement as outlined below.

Hard copies of the agreement shall be printed by the in-house District print shop. Upon ratification of the agreement, all Certified staff members that would like a printed copy will use a District provided form to request a physical copy. New hires will be offered the option of a printed copy during onboarding. All Union officers, Union building reps and District administrators will be given printed copies after ratification of any new agreement. Twenty-five (25) printed copies of the agreement will be given to the Lake County Federation for the Local.

IN WITNESS THEREOF:

For the Board of Education, Community
Consolidated School District No. 46,
Grayslake, Lake County, Illinois



President Date 10/16/25

For the Grayslake Federation of Teachers,
a Council of the Lake County Federation of
Teachers, Local 504, IFT-AFT/AFL-CIO



President Date 11/3/25



Secretary Date 10/15/25



Secretary Date 11/5/25

APPENDIX A WAGE/SALARY SCHEDULES

CERTIFIED										
	<i>2025-26 Salary Schedule*</i>									
Steps	BA - 0	BA - 8	BA - 16	BA - 24	BA - 32	MA - 0	MA - 8	MA - 16	MA - 24	MA - 32
1	\$45,317	\$46,303	\$47,290	\$48,276	\$49,263	\$51,236	\$53,209	\$55,183	\$57,149	\$62,671
2	\$45,756	\$46,753	\$47,750	\$48,744	\$49,741	\$51,734	\$53,726	\$55,719	\$57,703	\$63,279
3	\$46,193	\$47,198	\$48,204	\$49,209	\$50,215	\$52,226	\$54,237	\$56,249	\$58,254	\$63,883
4	\$46,632	\$47,648	\$48,663	\$49,677	\$50,692	\$52,725	\$54,754	\$56,785	\$58,808	\$64,490
5	\$47,088	\$48,112	\$49,138	\$50,161	\$51,188	\$53,238	\$55,288	\$57,338	\$59,382	\$65,120
6	\$47,592	\$48,629	\$49,666	\$50,700	\$51,737	\$53,810	\$55,881	\$57,954	\$60,019	\$65,819
7	\$48,289	\$49,341	\$50,391	\$51,443	\$52,493	\$54,597	\$56,699	\$58,803	\$60,898	\$66,782
8	\$49,240	\$50,313	\$51,386	\$52,455	\$53,528	\$55,672	\$57,816	\$59,961	\$62,097	\$68,097
9	\$50,212	\$51,304	\$52,398	\$53,489	\$54,583	\$56,770	\$58,955	\$61,142	\$63,322	\$69,439
10	\$51,718	\$52,844	\$53,969	\$55,094	\$56,220	\$58,473	\$60,724	\$62,975	\$65,221	\$71,522
11	\$53,270	\$54,429	\$55,588	\$56,747	\$57,908	\$60,228	\$62,546	\$64,865	\$67,178	\$73,669
12	\$55,052	\$56,252	\$57,451	\$58,648	\$59,847	\$62,246	\$64,642	\$67,039	\$69,427	\$76,135
13	\$56,678	\$57,877	\$59,079	\$60,273	\$61,473	\$63,870	\$66,267	\$68,664	\$71,056	\$77,761
14	\$57,812	\$59,637	\$60,839	\$62,034	\$63,235	\$65,632	\$68,026	\$70,425	\$72,819	\$79,527
15	\$59,749	\$61,455	\$62,656	\$63,850	\$65,049	\$67,447	\$69,840	\$72,240	\$74,633	\$81,342
16	\$61,751	\$63,322	\$64,524	\$65,718	\$66,913	\$69,314	\$71,710	\$74,107	\$76,500	\$83,209
17	\$63,819	\$65,241	\$66,439	\$67,637	\$68,833	\$71,234	\$73,628	\$76,027	\$78,420	\$85,132
18	\$65,957	\$66,761	\$68,423	\$69,618	\$70,818	\$73,217	\$75,612	\$78,008	\$80,406	\$87,114
19	\$68,167	\$68,997	\$70,543	\$71,740	\$72,936	\$75,333	\$77,729	\$80,131	\$82,524	\$89,232
20	\$70,450	\$71,309	\$72,920	\$74,148	\$75,376	\$77,834	\$80,287	\$82,748	\$85,198	\$92,032

***Rows 1-20 equate to steps and not years of teaching experience.**

CERTIFIED

2026-27 Salary Schedule*

Steps	BA - 0	BA - 8	BA - 16	BA - 24	BA - 32	MA - 0	MA - 8	MA - 16	MA - 24	MA - 32
1	\$45,883	\$46,882	\$47,881	\$48,879	\$49,879	\$51,877	\$53,874	\$55,872	\$57,863	\$63,455
2	\$46,328	\$47,337	\$48,347	\$49,354	\$50,363	\$52,381	\$54,398	\$56,415	\$58,425	\$64,070
3	\$46,770	\$47,788	\$48,807	\$49,824	\$50,843	\$52,879	\$54,915	\$56,952	\$58,982	\$64,681
4	\$47,215	\$48,243	\$49,271	\$50,299	\$51,326	\$53,383	\$55,438	\$57,495	\$59,544	\$65,297
5	\$47,676	\$48,714	\$49,752	\$50,788	\$51,827	\$53,904	\$55,980	\$58,056	\$60,124	\$65,934
6	\$48,188	\$49,236	\$50,287	\$51,333	\$52,384	\$54,482	\$56,579	\$58,678	\$60,769	\$66,642
7	\$48,893	\$49,957	\$51,022	\$52,086	\$53,150	\$55,280	\$57,408	\$59,537	\$61,659	\$67,617
8	\$49,856	\$50,942	\$52,028	\$53,112	\$54,197	\$56,368	\$58,539	\$60,710	\$62,874	\$68,948
9	\$50,840	\$51,945	\$53,053	\$54,157	\$55,265	\$57,479	\$59,691	\$61,907	\$64,113	\$70,307
10	\$52,365	\$53,505	\$54,644	\$55,783	\$56,923	\$59,204	\$61,483	\$63,762	\$66,036	\$72,416
11	\$53,936	\$55,110	\$56,283	\$57,457	\$58,631	\$60,980	\$63,328	\$65,676	\$68,018	\$74,589
12	\$55,741	\$56,955	\$58,169	\$59,382	\$60,596	\$63,024	\$65,450	\$67,877	\$70,295	\$77,088
13	\$57,386	\$58,600	\$59,817	\$61,027	\$62,242	\$64,669	\$67,096	\$69,523	\$71,945	\$78,732
14	\$58,535	\$60,382	\$61,600	\$62,809	\$64,025	\$66,452	\$68,876	\$71,305	\$73,729	\$80,520
15	\$59,705	\$62,223	\$63,438	\$64,647	\$65,862	\$68,290	\$70,713	\$73,143	\$75,566	\$82,359
16	\$61,706	\$64,114	\$65,331	\$66,540	\$67,750	\$70,180	\$72,607	\$75,034	\$77,457	\$84,249
17	\$63,773	\$66,056	\$67,271	\$68,484	\$69,692	\$72,124	\$74,548	\$76,977	\$79,400	\$86,196
18	\$65,909	\$67,595	\$69,278	\$70,488	\$71,703	\$74,132	\$76,556	\$78,983	\$81,411	\$88,203
19	\$68,117	\$69,170	\$71,425	\$72,637	\$73,848	\$76,276	\$78,701	\$81,132	\$83,555	\$90,346
20	\$70,399	\$71,488	\$73,831	\$75,075	\$76,319	\$78,806	\$81,291	\$83,783	\$86,264	\$93,183

***Rows 1-20 equate to steps and not years of teaching experience.**

CERTIFIED

2027-28 Salary Schedule*

Steps	BA - 0	BA - 8	BA - 16	BA - 24	BA - 32	MA - 0	MA - 8	MA - 16	MA - 24	MA - 32
1	\$46,342	\$47,351	\$48,360	\$49,368	\$50,377	\$52,396	\$54,413	\$56,431	\$58,442	\$64,089
2	\$46,791	\$47,811	\$48,830	\$49,847	\$50,867	\$52,905	\$54,942	\$56,980	\$59,009	\$64,711
3	\$47,237	\$48,266	\$49,295	\$50,322	\$51,351	\$53,408	\$55,464	\$57,522	\$59,572	\$65,327
4	\$47,687	\$48,726	\$49,764	\$50,802	\$51,840	\$53,917	\$55,993	\$58,070	\$60,139	\$65,949
5	\$48,153	\$49,201	\$50,249	\$51,296	\$52,345	\$54,442	\$56,539	\$58,636	\$60,726	\$66,593
6	\$48,669	\$49,729	\$50,789	\$51,847	\$52,907	\$55,028	\$57,146	\$59,265	\$61,377	\$67,308
7	\$49,382	\$50,457	\$51,532	\$52,606	\$53,681	\$55,833	\$57,982	\$60,132	\$62,276	\$68,293
8	\$50,355	\$51,452	\$52,549	\$53,643	\$54,739	\$56,932	\$59,124	\$61,317	\$63,503	\$69,638
9	\$51,348	\$52,465	\$53,583	\$54,699	\$55,817	\$58,054	\$60,289	\$62,526	\$64,755	\$71,011
10	\$52,888	\$54,040	\$55,191	\$56,340	\$57,492	\$59,795	\$62,098	\$64,400	\$66,696	\$73,140
11	\$54,476	\$55,660	\$56,846	\$58,031	\$59,218	\$61,590	\$63,961	\$66,333	\$68,698	\$75,335
12	\$56,299	\$57,525	\$58,751	\$59,976	\$61,202	\$63,654	\$66,105	\$68,555	\$70,998	\$77,858
13	\$57,961	\$59,186	\$60,416	\$61,637	\$62,865	\$65,316	\$67,766	\$70,218	\$72,664	\$79,521
14	\$59,119	\$60,987	\$62,216	\$63,437	\$64,666	\$67,117	\$69,565	\$72,019	\$74,466	\$81,325
15	\$60,302	\$62,844	\$64,073	\$65,293	\$66,520	\$68,973	\$71,419	\$73,874	\$76,321	\$83,183
16	\$61,509	\$64,755	\$65,983	\$67,204	\$68,428	\$70,883	\$73,333	\$75,785	\$78,231	\$85,092
17	\$63,569	\$66,718	\$67,943	\$69,168	\$70,390	\$72,846	\$75,294	\$77,747	\$80,195	\$87,058
18	\$65,699	\$68,271	\$69,972	\$71,194	\$72,420	\$74,873	\$77,322	\$79,773	\$82,225	\$89,085
19	\$67,900	\$69,862	\$72,139	\$73,363	\$74,586	\$77,038	\$79,487	\$81,943	\$84,390	\$91,250
20	\$70,175	\$71,490	\$74,570	\$75,825	\$77,082	\$79,595	\$82,104	\$84,620	\$87,126	\$94,114

***Rows 1-20 equate to steps and not years of teaching experience.**